

Making a VR room

Here's all the things you need to set up a dedicated virtual reality room at home.
<http://dgit.in/VRroom>



Longest sentence ever

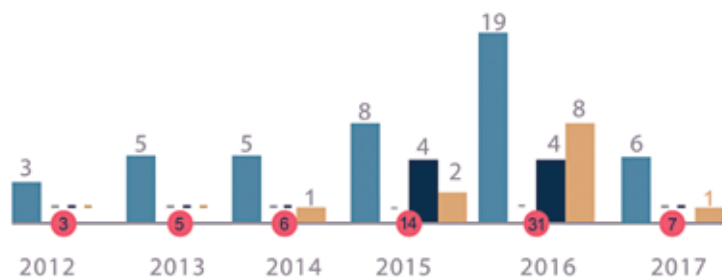
Russian hacker Roman Seleznev gets sentenced to 27 years in prison for hacking.
<http://dgit.in/27prison>

Feature

SOURCE: SFLC.IN

KIND OF SERVICE RESTRICTED

■ Mobile ■ Fixed-line ■ Both ■ Information not available ■ Total



India portrays a greater tendency to block mobile internet services entirely, compared to other possible measures

to a broadband connection. In comparison, countries like Brazil, Egypt and Uganda have taken a different approach by blocking specific services like WhatsApp, Telegram and certain social media apps – which definitely seems like a less restrictive approach.

In case you're wondering "So what if mobile internet was blocked – people could still access it via desktops and other media right?" – then you're grossly misinformed about internet usage in India. About 323 million people in India accessed the internet through their mobile phones in 2016, which corresponds to about 24-25 percent of the country's population. So, one in every four Indians is affected by restrictions on mobile internet – which is a pretty high number to ignore. To put it in context, imagine a religious legislation ignoring the impact on every single minority religion in India! Not something that you will see people taking silently, right?

WHAT CAN BE DONE

First of all, you need to believe that there is something that needs to be done. This cannot be a time when we get used to internet blockages as something that just 'happens'. Let's face it, there are situations where you can justify such a blockage with public unrest in context. But it's very important to understand what we are losing in the process. Putting a roadblock on the internet

blocks all communication online – even legitimate and helpful ones.

During the Cauvery riots in Bangalore in September 2016, Bangalore Police put forward a stellar example of how technology can be used to help people during chaotic situations. Riots in different parts of the city over a Supreme Court order, combined with WhatsApp forwards that spread misinformation presented a so-called 'ideal' case for internet blockage. Instead, Bangalore Police took to Twitter to clarify any such instances of misinformation. They also ensured that their WhatsApp accounts replied to any queries regarding general safety around the city. Even though there was a lot of damage

and chaos due to the riots, the scale was effectively brought down greatly because of access to a genuine source of information. In another example, during the Boston Bombings of 2013 – the internet became the only tool that could deal with the internet. Boston PD also took to social media within 10 minutes of the bombing to ensure that accurate updates overrule misinformation and the then-ongoing social media witch hunt was reigned in.

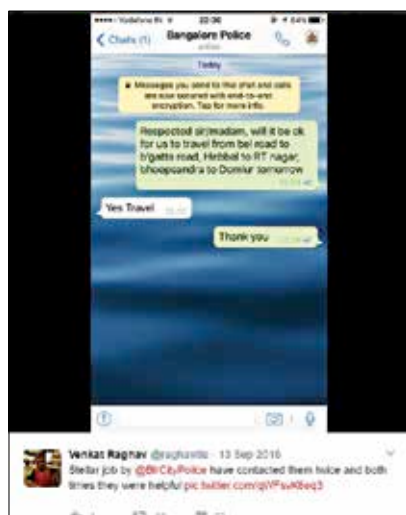
WHAT CAN YOU DO

Blocking the access to a communication medium hampers a lot of good outcomes in comparison to preventing misinformation. And more often than not, governments around the world have used internet blockages as a method to silence the voice of journalists, activists and voices of dissent. Thanks to the internet, there are quite a few things you can do to ensure that your internet access isn't taken away.

First of all, you can check out and sign the petition from Keep Us Online, a campaign by the Internet Freedom Foundation, at <http://dgit.in/KpUsOnln>. The petition is addressed to the Prime Minister of India and is also marked to relevant Ministers and government employees – with an aim of reaching 1,00,000 signatures to be sent.

Almost all the NGOs involved in this movement – AccessNow, Internet Freedom Foundation and more – do accept donations as well to keep the movement going and to get more people involved from a tech standpoint. And if you want to take things one step further and be directly involved in making sure that internet is always within our reach, you can always join these organisations. Both AccessNow and Internet Freedom Foundation are accepting applications for volunteers, interns and even full-time positions.

The important thing here is for you to know that this isn't something where you can just sit by and watch it unfold. 'Cause if that's what happens, the very internet that you take for granted might one day be yanked away from under your feet without warning.



An example of how Bangalore Police carried out their efforts